Moisture absorption	:	8.5%
Dimensional Stability	:	Good
Acids	:	Damages, Weakens fibre
Alkalis	:	Resistant (mercerization)
Effect of sunlight	:	Weakens fibre slowly
Insects	:	Silverfish damages fibre
To flame	:	Burns readily
Shape	:	Fairly uniform in width, 12-20, length varies from ½ and 2 ½inches

Definition of important terms:

Elasticity: The ability of a fibre or fabric to return to its original length, shape, or size immediately after the removal of stress.

Density: Explains the thickness of textile products.

Tenacity: The customary measure of strength of a yarn.

Resilience: The ability of a material to absorb energy when it is deformed elastically, and release that energy upon unloading.

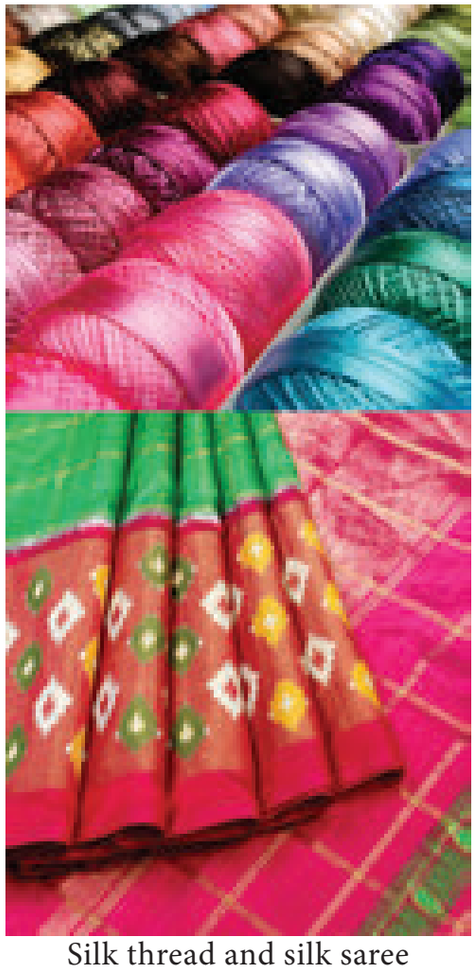
iii. Uses:

- Cotton is the most widely used fibre because it is inexpensive, easy-care, high absorbency, excellent launder ability and good colour fastness.
- It is not only used for apparel but also for household and industrial applications.

B. Silk

E2T33X

Silk has been considered as one of the most elegant and luxurious of fibres. It is popularly known as the "**Queen of Fibres**". The method of raising silk worms and removing the silk filaments from the cocoons and of using the silk in weaving for garments was discovered by **Hsi-Ling-Chi**, a little empress of China.



Silk thread and silk saree

Silk can be cultivated or it is found in forest as wild silk. Cultivated silk is the Mulberry silk. The common wild silk varieties are Eri, Tasar and Muga silk. The process of cultivating silkworm for silk production is called as sericulture.

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